ensure peace and stability in the region.

India and Russia

Indo-Russian friendship is a time-tested relationship. No one has been such a trusted friend as has been Russia for India. Undoubtedly, there have been some hiccups immediately after the disintegration of Soviet Union and certain matters related to defence deal, yet both have nurtured strong bond over the years. Immediately after the independence of India, there were some differences on international issues related to India's membership to Commonwealth, opposition to Communist revolution in Malaya, adoption of non-alignment policy, and also support to Greece among others. Soviet Union was suspicious about India's foreign policy posture as pro-West. However, the initial misgivings soon disappeared with the death of Stalin and Khrushchev's assumption of office of the President. In the 1950s when military pacts were being formed by USA to counter Communist threat, India's refusal to join such pact/alliances as opposed to Pakistan, and sticking to non-alignment, brought the two countries together. Thereafter, both had agreed on matters like Suez crisis and disagreed on Hungary, yet both moved on amicably in their bilateral relations. In 1962, during the Sino-Indian war, Soviet Union supported India whole heartedly, sided with India and also extended proposals for defence cooperation like manufacture of M.I.G Fighter Planes. During the 1965 Indo-Pak war, Soviet Union mediated peace between India and Pakistan and thus the Tashkent Declaration (1966) was signed.

The year 1971 was eventful, and Soviet Union and India entered into the Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation. The Preamble to the Treaty reaffirms both countries' faith in "the principles of peaceful co-existence and co-operation between states with different political and social systems." The noticeable point of this treaty was that there would be reciprocal consultations in case either of parties was subjected to an attack. Both also pledged to refrain from concluding military alliances against each other. Both also committed to enhance economic, scientific and technological cooperation. Thus, we find that Soviet Union helped India to set up Iron factory at Bhilai and Iron and steel factory at Bokaro. Arya Bhatta, the first artificial